SevenShield

Quick guide · Version 1.0

What does SevenShield do?

SevenShield encrypts folders and files on your computer. Locked content can only be opened again with your password or the matching recovery key. This also applies if the computer is lost or stolen. SevenShield processes your data only on your own computer. You can pass a locked file on by email, and the recipient opens it with SevenShield free of charge. You can also encrypt email messages with attachments. The recipient reads them free of charge on a computer or on a phone.

The buttons at a glance

If you briefly hover the mouse over a button, SevenShield shows what it does.

Add folder...	Selects a folder and adds it to the list.
Add file...	Selects one or more files. Alternatively, you can simply drag folders and files into the window.
Scan...	Searches a folder for items that are already locked and adds them to the list.
Remove	Removes the marked items from the list. The folders and files themselves remain unchanged.
Send encrypted file	Prepares a locked file for sending by email (see section 4). Active when a single locked file is marked or is the only item in the list.
Encrypt a message	The envelope at the top right opens the window for an encrypted email message with attachments (see section 8).
Send feedback	The speech bubble at the top right opens the feedback window (see section 7).
Show password	Shows or hides the password you entered.
Use existing recovery key	Optional: an existing recovery key is used instead of a new one.
Lock / Unlock	The main button. The icon shows what happens when you click: closed padlock to lock, open padlock to unlock.

1. Installation and license

Step 1: Install SevenShield

Run the installer and follow the instructions. At the end, you can start SevenShield right away. The installation also links the .7sv extension to SevenShield: double-clicking a locked file in Explorer or in an email starts the program and puts the file in the list.

Step 2: Activate the license (only for locking and sending)

SevenShield always starts right away. Without a license it works in read-only mode: unlocking is free, so recipients of files you send can open them without buying anything. When you want to lock or send, the activation window appears with your device code. Send it to the seller with “Send by email”. Select the license file you receive with “Select license file...” and click “Activate”. The license is valid for this computer.

2. Lock folders or files

Step 1: Add

Add folders or files using the buttons on the right, or drag them into the window.

Step 2: **Set a password**

Enter a password with at least 12 characters and repeat it in the second field. The indicator next to the field rates its strength from “Too short” through “Weak” and “Medium” to “Strong”. If the password is weak, SevenShield asks whether you want to use it anyway.

Step 3: **Lock**

Click the blue button with the padlock and confirm the prompt with “Yes”. Each file becomes a locked file with the extension .7sv. The original files are removed in the process.

Step 4: **Save the recovery key**

SevenShield then shows a separate recovery key for each item. Save it with “Copy all” or “Save as text file…”, tick the checkbox and click “Close”. Keep the key separate from the password and not in the same folder as the locked data. It is shown only this one time.

> **Important:** Either the password or the recovery key is enough to unlock. Without either, the data cannot be recovered.

3. Unlock and open

Step 1: **Item in the list**

Locked items are marked by a closed padlock in the list and in the status line. If the item is missing, bring it into the list with “Add folder…”, “Add file…” or “Scan…”, or double-click the .7sv file in Explorer.

Step 2: **Enter the password**

Enter the password that was used to lock the item.

Step 3: **Unlock**

Click the blue button with the open padlock. Unlocking also works without a license.

Step 4: **Open**

Double-click the item to open the file in the matching program or the folder in Explorer. Right-clicking also offers “Show in Explorer”.

4. Send a locked file by email

For sending, SevenShield creates a copy with its own one-time password. Your own password stays secret, and the original remains unchanged. You can send a single locked file. A license is required.

Step 1: **Open the send window**

Mark the file (or leave it as the only item in the list) and click the button with the paper plane. If your password is already entered in the main window, it is used. Otherwise the send window asks for it and you confirm with “Continue”. The password is only used to prepare the copy and is not sent.

Step 2: **Send the file by email**

If you like, choose the salutation (“Neutral”, “Mr” or “Ms”) and enter the recipient’s name: the last name for Mr or Ms, first and last name for Neutral. Use “Edit email text…” to change the subject and text. Do not write a password or anything confidential there, because the email is not encrypted. Click “Open email” and drag the file from the field into the email with the mouse. Check that it appears as an attachment, send the email and tick “I have sent the email WITH the file attached.” Without an email program, SevenShield marks the file in Explorer so you can send it by hand.

Step 3: **Pass on the password separately**

After you tick the checkbox, the buttons become available. The field shows the one-time password for this copy. “Print” creates a sheet with the password and instructions for opening the file. “WhatsApp” and “Telegram” open the respective app with a prepared message. “Copy” puts the password on the clipboard, which is cleared after 60 seconds.

> **Important:** Never send the file and the password the same way. The recipient needs SevenShield (sevenshield.de), drags the .7sv file into the window or double-clicks it, enters the one-time password and clicks “Unlock”. This is free of charge.

5. Several items at once

Hold down the Ctrl key to mark several items and process only those. If nothing is marked, SevenShield processes all items in the list.

- A password only works for items that were locked with exactly this password.

- If locked and unlocked items are mixed, the main button shows two arrows. One click locks the unlocked items and unlocks the locked ones.
- If several items are newly locked, you get an overview of all new recovery keys at the end.

6. Forgot your password?

If exactly one locked item is in the list, the link “Forgot your password? Unlock with recovery key” appears below the password field. Click it and enter the saved key. Remove any other items from the list first with “Remove”.

7. Send feedback

Use the speech bubble at the top right to reach us with a question, a problem or a suggestion. Choose the category and briefly describe your request. The field “This will be sent (read-only)” shows in advance what is transmitted: category, program version, language and your message. File names, paths, folder contents or passwords are never included. “Create email” opens your own email program. Alternatively, copy the text to the clipboard.

8. Encrypt and send a message

Instead of a file, SevenShield can also encrypt a text, for example for confidential details that should not appear in plain text in an email. You can add up to 20 files as attachments, up to 25 MB in total. A license is required.

Step 1: Write the message

Click the envelope at the top right. Write your text; a spell checker helps. Add attachments with “Add file…” or drag them into the window. Click “Continue”.

Step 2: Send the message

The same send window as in section 4 opens. SevenShield creates the file “SevenShield-Message.7sv” with its own one-time password. Drag the file into the email, send the email, tick the checkbox and pass on the password separately.

Step 3: Read the message

On a computer, SevenShield is enough (free of charge): double-click the .7sv file, enter the password, and the message appears in its own window. It is not saved anywhere. The recipient saves attachments one by one with “Save…” or all at once with “Save all…”. On a phone, no installation is needed (see section 9).

> **Important:** The subject, sender and recipient of the email remain readable. Write confidential details only in the message itself, and never send the password with the email.

9. Open a message on a phone (iPhone and Android)

The recipient needs no app on the phone. They open the page sevenshield.de/oeffnen in the browser, choose the saved file and enter the password. The message is decrypted on the device: the file and the password are not uploaded. This is free of charge and works with Safari, Chrome and other current browsers, also on a computer without SevenShield. Anyone who wants to be completely sure can download the offline version from that page and verify it with the checksum shown there.

1 **Save attachment** → 2 **Open page** → 3 **Choose file** → 4 **Enter password**

iPhone (Safari)

1. Open the email and tap the attachment “SevenShield-Message.7sv”.
2. Tap the share icon and choose “Save to Files”. Confirm with “Save”.
3. Open sevenshield.de/oeffnen in Safari. The link is in the email.
4. Tap “Choose file”, then in the menu the entry for files (“Choose Files” or “Browse”) and select the saved file.
5. Enter the password and tap “Open”.

Android (Chrome)

1. In the email, tap the “Download” icon on the attachment. The file is then in the “Downloads” folder.
2. Open sevenshield.de/oeffnen in Chrome. The link is in the email.
3. Tap “Choose file” and select the file in the “Downloads” folder.
4. Enter the password and tap “Open”.

Tips

- The password can be copied from WhatsApp or Telegram and pasted into the field. Mind upper and lower case.
- Save attachments with “Save” next to the attachment. On iPhone, find the file afterwards via the arrow in the Safari address bar (Downloads) or in the Files app in the “Downloads” folder. On Android, use the notification or the Files app.
- When you are done, tap “Close and delete”. You can then delete the saved .7sv file.

Good to know

- While SevenShield is working, the program cannot be closed. This way, no half-processed data is left behind.
- If a locked file has been changed or damaged, for example cut short, SevenShield reports an error when unlocking and creates no file. Files locked with older versions can still be unlocked but do not have this additional protection. Lock them again if needed.
- The language follows your Windows setting: German, English, French or Italian.

In short

- **Lock:** Add → set password → padlock button → save key
- **Unlock:** item in the list → enter password → padlock button → double-click to open
- **Send:** paper plane → send email with attachment → tick the checkbox → send one-time password separately
- **Message:** envelope → text and attachments → Continue → drag the file into the email → send the password separately
- **Read on a phone:** save attachment → sevenshield.de/oeffnen → choose file → enter password
- **Forgot your password:** use the recovery key